

Fiebig to the rescue

Westlake sophomore's late heroics propel Demons to victory over North Olmsted

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

WESTLAKE — Zarrett Fiebig, a lanky sophomore, calmly scored six straight points Saturday night, lifting Westlake to an important Southwestern Conference basketball victory.

The last five points in this string came in the last 34 seconds, and it pulled the Demons out of a 42-38 hole, boosting them to an exciting 43-42 win over North Olmsted in a game finally decided by a missed shot at the buzzer.

The game was especially important for the Eagles, 10-5, 7-3 SWC. The loss dropped them two full games behind Olmsted Falls and Rocky River, which are tied for the conference lead at 9-1.

The Eagles still have a shot at the title, but will need help with just four games left on the SWC schedule. They'll get a chance to help themselves Friday night at Olmsted Falls. Falls won the first meeting, 54-43.

With the victory, Westlake improved to 8-8, 6-4.

The game went down to the last tick, with North Olmsted in the thick of it right to the end.

But the Eagles' Gerard Meczka just missed a two-point shot from the left side of the hoop that would have won it as time ran out.

It was the second meeting of the teams this season and the second time the winner hung on by

North Olmsted					Westlake				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Jane	1	0	0	Diamond	2	2	1	8	5
Kier	1	0	0	Jones	2	2	0	0	0
Steele	1	2	4	Gulano	2	2	0	0	0
Ryan	2	0	0	Noel	5	0	0	0	0
Grodek	0	0	0	Pell	0	2	0	0	0
Hazzard	0	0	1	Heller	0	2	0	0	0
Meczka	4	0	8	Fiebig	3	3	4	10	2
Husak	6	3	17	Inch	1	0	0	0	0
Wright	2	0	4	Machuca	1	0	0	0	0
			Fischer	1	0	0	0	0	0
			Verdova	0	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	16	5	42	Totals	15	11	43		

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
15 12 4 11 — 42

Three-point goals: North Olmsted — Husak 2, Jane, Ryan, Westlake — Hultsler, Diamond

Junior varsity: North Olmsted 56-48

a single point North Olmsted won at home, 52-51, on Dec. 20.

Westlake trailed, 42-38 when the 6-foot-3 Fiebig drove for a layup from the left side, made it and was fouled on the play with 34.4 seconds to go. He made the free throw to cut the North Olmsted lead to 42-41.

The Eagles, who had already turned the ball over 13 times in the second half, turned it over again on the inbounds play that followed. The ball wound up in Fiebig's hands and he was fouled in the act of shooting with 20.6 seconds to play.

He made both shots and Westlake was a winner.

"I'm so proud of these kids," said Westlake coach Art Daniels. "It was a great win for them. They (Eagles) hurt us inside with their rebounding (14-4 first half, 23-15 game) and Meczka and (Mike) Husak hurt us with their scoring inside the first half. But we were able to make some

adjustments and slow them down in the second half."

Meczka and Husak combined for 16 of the Eagles' first-half points. But they scored only nine between them the third and fourth quarters.

And Westlake held North Olmsted's strong post player, 6-5 Ryan Wingenfeld, to just four points for the night, after he had scored 24 in a victory over Avon Lake a night earlier.

"We never quit," Daniels said, "and it gave us a real spark when (Mike) Diamond came off the bench in the fourth quarter, got a steal for us and hit that 3-point-er."

In fact, Westlake was down, 36-34, at the time and Diamond's trey with 4:15 to play gave the Demons their first lead since the score was 5-4 halfway through the first quarter.

North Olmsted couldn't buy a basket the second half (6-of-28 from the field) and scored only four points the third quarter on 2-of-5 shooting to go with 11 turnovers.

"That third quarter really hurt us," said Eagle coach Tim Schmotzer. "The kids feel bad right now and they're going to need help to come back. They're very disappointed with this loss. But they didn't quit. They gave it a good effort and you can't ask for more than that."

Fiebig's 10 points led Westlake. Husak's 17 led all scorers.



TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE

RIVER WATCH: Rocky River's Connell Dolan surveys the situation in the Pirates' victory over Olmsted Falls Saturday night. The Bulldogs' Brian Williams defends.

RIVER

From D1
1995, when they fell 67-64 at Westlake.

Their last league loss at home was to Avon Lake 73-58 on Feb. 11, 1995.

Rucki was gracious, but the Rocky River students didn't miss a chance to let Olmsted Falls fans have a taste of their own medicine.

"We've taken some abuse from their student section, and I think our guys let off a little steam," Rucki said.

"The winning streak was never an issue with us," said Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue, whose team had an 11-game winning streak stopped.

Both teams have four league games remaining, and both will face North Olmsted, but Donahue said that Rocky River should do no worse than tie for the championship.

"They have an awesome team," the Falls coach said. "There is no reason that they should lose another game."

Rocky River, 13-2, is at Westlake Friday and closes its schedule at home against North Olmsted. Olmsted Falls will host North Olmsted Friday.

O Falls					R River				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Williams	6	2	16	Kennedy	5	0	10	0	0
Radigan	5	1	13	Dolan	5	0	0	0	0
Williams	0	0	0	Woodward	1	0	2	0	0
Knapp	0	0	0	Caruso	9	6	0	14	0
Mucha	0	0	0	Peate	6	0	0	0	0
Gansley	4	0	8	Clutterbuck	2	0	0	0	0
Szozach	1	0	0	Rickard	1	0	0	0	0
Holland	0	0	0	Ferguson	0	0	0	0	0
JMiller	0	0	0	DMiller	0	0	0	0	0
Koch	0	0	0						
Jaroscak	0	0	0						
Totals	17	5	44	Totals	23	5	56		

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
12 13 11 15 — 58

Three-point goals: Olmsted Falls — Radigan 2, M Williams 2, Knapp, Rocky River — Caruso 3, Peate 2

JV Rocky River 58-40

of the way.

"We were very disappointed after the first game," said Rocky River's John Caruso, who scored a game-high 25 points, 13 in the third quarter. "We kinda let ourselves down."

"They were hyped up the first game and they took us by surprise. This time we weren't overconfident. We just came out and played harder, with more heart and intensity."

"When we came out Rocky River looked more relaxed than we were, and it shouldn't have been that way," Donahue said.

Other than an opening-game loss to Chancel, Olmsted Falls hadn't played from behind all year.

"After the first quarter, we've been up in every game," Donahue said. "We'd get the lead down to two or three, but we couldn't get over the hump."

Rocky River won because it handled Olmsted Falls' pressure defense. The Pirates had 16 turnovers, a modest number when compared to other Olmsted Falls opponents. The Bulldogs had 18 turnovers.

The Pirates also won the rebound battle 34-29 and had a big edge in shooting percentage — 46.9 percent to 37.7 percent.

Moon, Hughes spark Saints

LORAIN — Alexander Edsel's game-high 27 points weren't enough to help his team overcome the scoring duo of Southview's Devon Moon and Damien Hughes.

Moon scored 24 points and Hughes added 18 as Southview dumped Warrensville, 71-54, Saturday night.

With the win, the Saints improved to 5-10. They will head to Vermilion Friday night.

Warrensville's Dante Griffin scored 11 points.

Warrens					Southview				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Edsel	8	7	27	Lighty	3	1	5	7	1
Smith	1	0	2	Sienkiewicz	2	1	0	2	0
Wright	0	0	0	Rodriguez	1	0	0	0	0
Adkinson	2	1	5	Hughes	8	2	18	0	0
Appelner	1	0	2	Thames	3	3	9	0	0
Harp	0	1	1	Guerra	1	3	4	0	0
Griffin	5	1	11	Moon	10	4	24	0	0
Chandler	1	1	3	Whitson	1	0	2	0	0
Totals	18	44	64	Totals	30	12	71		

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 OT T
12 17 13 12 — 54

Warrens — 12 17 13 12 — 54

Southview — 24 14 12 21 — 71

Three-point goals: Warrensville — Edsel (4), Southview — Remakus

JV Warrensville — 45-39

TOLEDO — Toledo Start outscored the Admirals 31-18 in the fourth quarter in non-conference action.

Aaron Whitehead led Admiral King with 14 points.

The Admirals, 10-5, will travel to Willoughby South Friday.

King					Start				
G	F	T	G	F	T	G	F	T	G
Coleman	2	2	9	Abbott	0	5	2	12	1
Feliciano	3	0	7	Worthy	0	1	1	1	1
Hornbush	1	0	2	Hughes	6	2	14	0	0
Ransom	3	1	9	Daniels	5	1	11	0	0
Wooten	4	0	8	Whitstone	1	2	4	0	0

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